

GED Social Studies Practice Test 7

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC7-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state requires large counties to provide election materials in more than one language when a significant number of eligible voters in that county have limited English proficiency. The ballots are the same for all voters, but translated instructions and trained interpreters are available at polling places.

Which civic goal is most directly supported by this requirement?

- A) Reducing access to voting for new citizens
- B) Helping eligible voters understand and participate in elections
- C) Allowing counties to change election results after voting ends
- D) Replacing ballots with public speeches

GED-SOC7-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city reports median monthly rent for one-bedroom apartments.

Year: 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023

Median rent: \$950, \$1,020, \$1,140, \$1,260

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) Median rent rose each year.
- B) Median rent stayed the same after 2020.
- C) Median rent was lowest in 2023.
- D) Median rent decreased from 2021 to 2022.

GED-SOC7-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the early 1800s, canals and improved roads helped connect farms in the interior to cities and ports. Farmers could sell more goods outside their local areas, and merchants could move manufactured products farther inland. These transportation improvements helped create stronger economic links among regions.

Which conclusion is best supported by this source?

- A) Internal improvements helped expand market connections.
- B) Transportation improvements ended all regional differences.
- C) Farmers became completely independent from cities.
- D) Roads and canals reduced all trade between regions.

GED-SOC7-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region receives most of its rainfall during a predictable summer monsoon season. Farmers plant rice shortly before the rains begin and depend on canals to move water to fields. In years when the monsoon arrives late, planting is delayed and harvests may be smaller.

Which statement best explains the geographic relationship described?

- A) Seasonal climate patterns can shape agricultural schedules.
- B) Farming is unaffected by rainfall patterns.
- C) Monsoons prevent all settlement in river valleys.
- D) Canals are used only in regions with no rain.

GED-SOC7-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state uses a merit-based hiring system for many government jobs. Applicants take exams, submit work experience, and are ranked according to job-related qualifications. Officials say the system reduces political favoritism in hiring.

Which TWO statements best explain the civic purpose of this system?

- A) It helps public jobs be filled based on qualifications.
- B) It can reduce patronage and favoritism in government employment.
- C) It allows elected officials to hire only personal friends.
- D) It eliminates the need for government employees to follow laws.
- E) It gives courts the power to choose every state employee.

GED-SOC7-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A county official argues that federal grants for road safety are useful because rural counties cannot

always afford major safety upgrades on their own. The official says national funding helps local governments meet public needs.

Source B:

A state legislator argues that federal grants sometimes come with too many conditions. The legislator says local officials may know which projects matter most, but grant rules can pressure them to spend money in ways that fit federal priorities.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether federal grants can help local governments or limit local flexibility
- B) Whether counties should be allowed to hold elections
- C) Whether roads should be replaced by private courts
- D) Whether states may print their own national currency

GED-SOC7-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

After the Civil War, some Southern states passed laws that limited the freedom of formerly enslaved people. These laws restricted labor choices, movement, and other rights. In response, Congress debated stronger federal protections for citizenship and civil rights.

Which historical issue is most clearly described?

- A) Conflict over the meaning of freedom during Reconstruction
- B) Debate over radio ownership in the 1920s
- C) Conflict over joining NATO after World War II
- D) Debate over building the Panama Canal

GED-SOC7-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

The First Amendment's Establishment Clause limits government from [D1], while the Free Exercise Clause protects people's ability to [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) officially favoring or establishing a religion | regulating interstate trade | apportioning House seats

D2) practice religion within constitutional limits | declare war | issue state currency

GED-SOC7-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city has 200,000 people in the labor force. Of these, 12,000 are unemployed and actively looking

for work. What is the unemployment rate?

Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC7-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A country has two major regions. The northern region has oil fields and a small population. The southern region has most of the country's farmland and largest cities. Political leaders debate how tax revenue from oil should be distributed between regions.

Which geographic issue is most clearly shown?

- A) Uneven distribution of resources can create political and economic debates.
- B) Natural resources are always evenly distributed within a country.
- C) Farmland and oil fields always exist in the same region.
- D) Population patterns have no relationship to public policy.

GED-SOC7-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

A city gives public funds only to one religious organization to run a community program, even though several nonreligious and religious groups offer similar services. A court reviews whether the city's decision improperly favors one religion.

Which constitutional issue is most directly involved?

- A) Government establishment or favoritism toward religion
- B) The power to regulate foreign trade
- C) The right to a jury in civil cases
- D) State control of military alliances

GED-SOC7-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows output from one textile mill.

Year: 1820, 1840, 1860

Cloth produced: 90,000 yards, 310,000 yards, 740,000 yards

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) Textile production increased from 1820 to 1860.
- B) Textile production decreased after 1820.

- C) Textile production was highest in 1820.
- D) Textile production stayed unchanged over time.

GED-SOC7-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution creates a bicameral legislature with two chambers. A bill must usually pass both chambers before it can be sent to the governor. Supporters say this arrangement requires more than one group of representatives to review proposed laws.

Which statement best describes the purpose of bicameralism?

- A) It divides the legislative process between two chambers.
- B) It gives governors the power to appoint legislators.
- C) It allows courts to write bills directly.
- D) It removes voting from the lawmaking process.

GED-SOC7-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A central bank raises interest rates. Several months later, fewer households apply for home loans because borrowing has become more expensive. Some businesses also delay expansion plans because loan payments would be higher.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Interest rates can influence borrowing and spending decisions.
- B) Higher interest rates always increase borrowing.
- C) Loan costs have no effect on households or businesses.
- D) Businesses borrow only when interest rates are high.

GED-SOC7-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A town charter gives the mayor power to supervise departments and gives the council power to pass ordinances. The charter also states that both officials and residents must follow town ordinances unless a court rules otherwise.

Which civic principle is most clearly reflected?

- A) Government powers and duties are defined by law.
- B) Local officials may ignore written rules.
- C) Courts have no role in interpreting law.
- D) Residents are exempt from local ordinances.

GED-SOC7-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

In the late 1800s, industrial workers organized strikes to demand higher wages, shorter hours, and safer conditions. Business owners often argued that strikes interrupted production and threatened property. State and federal officials sometimes sent troops or used court orders to end labor unrest.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Industrialization produced conflicts between labor and management.
- B) Government sometimes became involved in labor disputes.
- C) Workers and business owners always agreed on wages and hours.
- D) Strikes had no effect on production.
- E) Labor unrest occurred only before factories existed.

GED-SOC7-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country reports population by region.

Region: North, Central, South, Coastal

Population: 2.1 million, 5.4 million, 3.8 million, 6.7 million

Which region has the largest population?

- A) North
- B) Central
- C) South
- D) Coastal

GED-SOC7-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state law requires public agencies to provide reasonable accommodations for qualified employees with disabilities, unless the accommodation would create an undue hardship. An employee requests modified equipment that would allow them to perform the essential duties of the job.

Which civic principle is best reflected in this policy?

- A) Equal opportunity in public employment
- B) Legislative punishment without a trial
- C) State power to conduct foreign policy
- D) Elimination of workplace rights

GED-SOC7-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state uses a graduated income tax.

Income range: \$0–\$25,000, \$25,001–\$75,000, Over \$75,000

Tax rate: 2%, 4%, 6%

Which statement best describes this tax structure?

- A) Higher income ranges are taxed at higher rates.
- B) Every income range is taxed at the same rate.
- C) Only people earning below \$25,000 pay taxes.
- D) The tax rate decreases as income rises.

GED-SOC7-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

When a state creates congressional districts, the process is called [D1]. When district lines are drawn to give one group an unfair political advantage, the practice is often called [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) redistricting | naturalization | impeachment

D2) gerrymandering | habeas corpus | bicameralism

GED-SOC7-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state legislature has 50 senators. A constitutional amendment proposal requires approval by three-fifths of the senators.

How many senators must approve the proposal?

- A) 20
- B) 25
- C) 30
- D) 35

GED-SOC7-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state requires lobbyists to register before they are paid to contact lawmakers about legislation. The registration form asks whom the lobbyist represents and which general issues the lobbyist works on.

What is the main purpose of this requirement?

- A) To identify organized efforts to influence public officials
- B) To ban all communication with lawmakers
- C) To allow lobbyists to cast votes in the legislature
- D) To remove citizens from the lawmaking process

GED-SOC7-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A province has 1,500,000 people and 50,000 square miles of land. What is the population density in people per square mile?

Type your answer as a whole number.

GED-SOC7-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

After World War II, the United States provided economic aid to several European countries to help rebuild factories, transportation systems, and trade. Supporters argued that economic recovery would make democratic governments more stable and reduce support for communist movements.

Which Cold War strategy is best reflected in this source?

- A) Using economic aid to strengthen allies and limit communist influence
- B) Ending all trade with Europe permanently
- C) Returning the United States to colonial rule
- D) Replacing European governments with U.S. state governments

GED-SOC7-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Establishment Clause
- B) Free Exercise Clause
- C) Equal Protection Clause
- D) Commerce Clause

Targets:

T1) Limits government from officially favoring a religion

- T2) Protects people's ability to practice religion within constitutional limits
T3) Requires states to provide fair treatment under the law

GED-SOC7-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city has more available apartments than renters looking for apartments. Some landlords begin offering one free month of rent or lower monthly prices to attract tenants.

Which economic concept best explains the landlords' actions?

- A) A surplus can put downward pressure on prices.
- B) A shortage always lowers supply.
- C) Higher prices always attract more renters.
- D) Rent prices are unrelated to available housing.

GED-SOC7-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A person volunteers to serve on a neighborhood emergency preparedness team. The team receives training, helps distribute safety information, and assists local officials during drills.

Which civic idea is best illustrated?

- A) Community service can support public safety.
- B) Volunteers may replace all elected officials.
- C) Emergency planning is unrelated to civic life.
- D) Only federal judges may assist during emergencies.

GED-SOC7-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state court rules that a law cannot give one company the exclusive right to operate all food stands in public parks unless the government provides a valid public reason. The court says laws should not create arbitrary special privileges.

Which conclusion is best supported by the ruling?

- A) Laws should serve a legitimate public purpose rather than unfairly favor one private party.
- B) Governments must give every business a monopoly.
- C) Courts cannot review laws affecting public parks.
- D) Food stands are exempt from all public regulation.

GED-SOC7-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

In the 1960s, Great Society programs were designed to address [D1], including through federal support for [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) poverty and unequal access to services | colonial taxation | westward land claims

D2) health care and education | private royal governors | overseas monarchies

GED-SOC7-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city council has 15 members. A zoning change requires approval by two-thirds of the council.

How many council members must approve the zoning change?

A) 5

B) 8

C) 10

D) 12

GED-SOC7-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A candidate says, "I lost the election, but the votes were counted under the rules that applied to all candidates. I will not claim victory without evidence, and I will run again next time if voters support me."

Which democratic norm is best shown by this statement?

A) Peaceful acceptance of election results

B) Rule by military command

C) Cancellation of future elections

D) Hereditary transfer of office

GED-SOC7-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state reports applications for absentee ballots.

Year: 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023

Applications: 180,000, 120,000, 150,000, 165,000

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) Applications were highest in 2020.
- B) Applications increased every year after 2020.
- C) Applications were lowest in 2021.
- D) Applications were the same in 2022 and 2023.
- E) Applications decreased from 2022 to 2023.

GED-SOC7-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A nation made up of many islands has limited farmland on several smaller islands. Many residents move to the largest island because it has the main airport, hospitals, government offices, and more jobs.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Access to services and jobs can influence internal migration.
- B) Islands cannot have population movement within one country.
- C) Airports prevent people from moving to cities.
- D) Government offices have no effect on settlement patterns.

GED-SOC7-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows federal highway spending during a period of interstate highway construction.

Year: 1956, 1965, 1975

Federal highway spending: \$1.8 billion, \$4.6 billion, \$7.9 billion

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) Federal highway spending increased from 1956 to 1975.
- B) Federal highway spending decreased after 1956.
- C) Spending was highest in 1956.
- D) Spending stayed exactly the same over the period.

GED-SOC7-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state ethics board says public officials may not use government computers, staff time, or official

email accounts to run private businesses. The board explains that public resources should be used for public duties, not private gain.

Which claim is best supported by the source?

- A) Public officials should separate public responsibilities from private financial interests.
- B) Public officials may use tax-funded resources for any private activity.
- C) Ethics rules apply only to private citizens.
- D) Government property cannot be regulated by law.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC7-001 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Helping eligible voters understand and participate in elections — Explanation: Translated instructions and interpreters help eligible voters understand the process and cast ballots.

GED-SOC7-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Median rent rose each year. — Explanation: Median rent increased from \$950 to \$1,260 over the four years.

GED-SOC7-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Internal improvements helped expand market connections. — Explanation: Roads and canals connected farms, cities, ports, and regional markets.

GED-SOC7-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Seasonal climate patterns can shape agricultural schedules. — Explanation: The timing of monsoon rains affects when farmers plant and how successful harvests may be.

GED-SOC7-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: It helps public jobs be filled based on qualifications. | It can reduce patronage and favoritism in government employment. — Explanation: Merit-based hiring uses qualifications rather than political loyalty or personal favoritism.

GED-SOC7-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether federal grants can help local governments or limit local flexibility — Explanation: Source A emphasizes the benefits of federal funding, while Source B emphasizes conditions that can reduce local control.

GED-SOC7-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Conflict over the meaning of freedom during Reconstruction — Explanation: The source describes postwar limits on freedpeople and debates over federal civil rights protections.

GED-SOC7-008 — Correct: D1=officially favoring or establishing a religion; D2=practice religion within constitutional limits — Correct Answer: D1=officially favoring or establishing a religion; D2=practice religion within constitutional limits — Explanation: The Establishment Clause limits government support for religion, while the Free Exercise Clause protects religious practice.

GED-SOC7-009 — Correct: 6 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 6 — Explanation: 12,000 unemployed workers divided by a labor force of 200,000 equals 6%.

GED-SOC7-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Uneven distribution of resources can create political and economic debates. — Explanation: Oil, farmland, cities, and population are unevenly distributed, creating debate over tax revenue.

GED-SOC7-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Government establishment or favoritism toward religion — Explanation: The court is considering whether the city improperly favored one religious organization.

GED-SOC7-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Textile production increased from 1820 to 1860. — Explanation: Cloth production rose from 90,000 yards to 740,000 yards.

GED-SOC7-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: It divides the legislative process between two chambers. — Explanation: Bicameralism means a legislature has two chambers that review proposed laws.

GED-SOC7-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Interest rates can influence borrowing and spending decisions. — Explanation: Higher interest rates make loans more expensive, reducing borrowing by households and businesses.

GED-SOC7-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Government powers and duties are defined by law. — Explanation: The town charter defines the powers of officials and requires everyone to follow legal rules.

GED-SOC7-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Industrialization produced conflicts between labor and management. | Government sometimes became involved in labor disputes. — Explanation: The description includes worker demands, employer opposition, and government intervention.

GED-SOC7-017 — Correct: D — Correct Answer: Coastal — Explanation: The Coastal region has the largest population at 6.7 million.

GED-SOC7-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Equal opportunity in public employment — Explanation: Reasonable accommodations help qualified employees with disabilities perform essential job duties.

GED-SOC7-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Higher income ranges are taxed at higher rates. — Explanation: The tax rates rise from 2% to 4% to 6% as income ranges increase.

GED-SOC7-020 — Correct: D1=redistricting; D2=gerrymandering — Correct Answer: D1=redistricting; D2=gerrymandering — Explanation: Redistricting is drawing district lines, while gerrymandering is drawing them for unfair political advantage.

GED-SOC7-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 30 — Explanation: Three-fifths of 50 is 30.

GED-SOC7-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: To identify organized efforts to influence public officials — Explanation: Lobbyist registration shows who is paid to influence lawmakers and on what issues.

GED-SOC7-023 — Correct: 30 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 30 — Explanation: 1,500,000 divided by 50,000 equals 30 people per square mile.

GED-SOC7-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Using economic aid to strengthen allies and limit communist influence — Explanation: The source describes aid used to rebuild allies and reduce support for communist movements.

GED-SOC7-025 — Correct: T1=A; T2=B; T3=C — Correct Answer: T1=Establishment Clause; T2=Free Exercise Clause; T3=Equal Protection Clause — Explanation: The Establishment Clause limits government support for religion, the Free Exercise Clause protects religious practice, and the Equal Protection Clause requires fair treatment under law.

GED-SOC7-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: A surplus can put downward pressure on prices. — Explanation: When apartments outnumber renters, landlords may lower prices or offer incentives.

GED-SOC7-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Community service can support public safety. — Explanation: Volunteering on an emergency preparedness team is civic participation that supports the community.

GED-SOC7-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Laws should serve a legitimate public purpose rather than unfairly favor one private party. — Explanation: The ruling objects to arbitrary special privileges without a valid public reason.

GED-SOC7-029 — Correct: D1=poverty and unequal access to services; D2=health care and education — Correct Answer: D1=poverty and unequal access to services; D2=health care and education — Explanation: Great Society programs addressed poverty and access to services, including health care and education.

GED-SOC7-030 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 10 — Explanation: Two-thirds of 15 is 10.

GED-SOC7-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Peaceful acceptance of election results — Explanation: The candidate accepts the outcome under common rules and does not claim victory without evidence.

GED-SOC7-032 — Correct: A,C — Correct Answer: Applications were highest in 2020. | Applications were lowest in 2021. — Explanation: The highest number was 180,000 in 2020, and the lowest was 120,000 in 2021.

GED-SOC7-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Access to services and jobs can influence internal migration. — Explanation: Residents move toward the largest island because it has jobs, transportation, hospitals, and government services.

GED-SOC7-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Federal highway spending increased from 1956 to 1975. — Explanation: Spending rose from \$1.8 billion to \$7.9 billion.

GED-SOC7-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Public officials should separate public responsibilities from private financial interests. — Explanation: The source says public resources should be used for public duties, not private business.